Nenthorn Nemesis Nocturnals or It is what happens after 10pm that really counts.

This was to be my team's fourth 24 hour rogaine. I was looking forward to having a better time than at last year's Green Coast rogaine when I barely managed to finish. In planning our route we tried to calculate a straight line distance of about 65km total, as this has seemed about right in other events. We decided to omit the south eastern corner as, by our calculations, it gave fewer points for the distance than the other three corners of the map. We also tried to pick a route that would have plenty of tops and well-defined points for night-time travel; the northern region appeared to fit the bill.

Pete Squire's electronic recording system worked marvellously. I think most of us had trouble believing that the plastic bottle top we hung round our necks would record anything. But all 49 of the checkpoint pens flashed cheerfully when touched to the bottle top and our final print out confirmed them all. The only hiccups were two of the time punches.

The table below says it all! Over the first nine hours (daylight) we averaged over three checkpoints and almost 200 points per hour. For the 10 hours of darkness we only found 10 checkpoints and scored 820 points. In the final daylight leg we found six checkpoints in four hours.

The terrain on the whole was less challenging than that of some other events, which produced a fast course. At 9pm we were three hours ahead of schedule. In retrospect, if we hadn't had such a plethora of problems during the night, our planned course would have been too short, although we did have options to pick up more controls towards the end. I can't help wondering if we would have had fewer navigational problems if we had added more controls at the beginning or chosen to travel in the opposite direction. On the other hand, our original calculations said that we should have reached daylight before the worst matagouri.

Not long after darkness fell one of our team became unwell (several teams at the north western water stop will bear witness to this!). He is unsure whether this was due to a bug, the heat, or too much exertion early on, although very sore feet later in the race suggest the latter two causes. Anyway, after a rest we decided to carry on, albeit slowly. Navigation is always more difficult at night but our assumption that we would be able to spot tops and gullies in this area of the course was wrong. Ever thickening matagouri made it impossible to follow a straight line compass bearing. Twice we spent nearly two hours without scoring. The first time was while failing to find checkpoint 72 and later on in making the dreadful trek between 82 and 100, down steep gullies: struggling across deep and overgrown streams, battling up steep banks through dense matagouri. In the darkness we were repeatedly missing gullies.

As dawn came our progress was getting slower and slower. We decided to bypass checkpoint 73 and somehow missed both 87 and 85. Obviously tiredness was starting to tell. Seeing Chris and Aaron RUNNING towards the last water stop spurred us on for a while. In the end we limped over the line over an hour early happy to have finished the event.

After a few days of rest I can say that it was another great rogaine, memorable for the heat, the night time matagouri and Pete's wonderful recording system. I am already looking forward to the next one and resolving to do much better with navigation!

Emma de Lacey

Table 1: Team #4 Recorded Results

Tag Line	Punch ID	Value	Time Punched	Split Time	Running Total
3	11	10	12:08:59 PM	0:08:59	10
4	22	20	12:13:57 PM	0:04:58	30
5	40	40	12:27:42 PM	0:13:45	70
6	80	80	12:41:57 PM	0:14:15	150
7	70	70	12:56:12 PM	0:14:15	220
8	51	50	1:15:40 PM	0:19:28	270
9	35	30	1:26:37 PM	0:10:57	300
10	61	60	1:44:19 PM	0:17:42	360
11	52	50	1:51:24 PM	0:07:05	410
12	91	90	2:01:09 PM	0:09:45	500
13	75	70	2:23:13 PM	0:22:04	570
14	48	40	2:33:25 PM	0:10:12	610
15	49	40	3:04:50 PM	0:31:25	650
16	92	90	3:17:39 PM	0:12:49	740
17	86	80	4:02:06 PM	0:44:27	820
18	64	60	4:14:30 PM	0:12:24	880
19	38	30	4:33:53 PM	0:19:23	910
20	56	50	4:44:00 PM	0:10:07	960
21	88	80	5:19:05 PM	0:35:05	1040
22	67	60	5:34:39 PM	0:15:34	1100
23	76	70	5:48:45 PM	0:14:06	1170
24	57	50	6:12:48 PM	0:24:03	1220
25	45	40	6:32:58 PM	0:20:10	1260
26	68	60	6:54:02 PM	0:21:04	1320
27	96	90	7:11:00 PM	0:16:58	1410
28	54	50	7:28:31 PM	0:17:31	1460
29	84	80	7:41:31 PM	0:13:00	1540
30	59	50	8:17:42 PM	0:36:11	1590
31	69	60	8:40:56 PM	0:23:14	1650
32	77	70	9:01:18 PM	0:20:22	1720
33	83	80	9:10:48 PM	0:09:30	1800
34	78	70	10:03:39 PM	0:52:51	1870
35	37	30	10:33:54 PM	0:30:15	1900
36	102	100	11:21:00 PM	0:47:06	2000
37	93	90	11:37:09 PM	0:16:09	2090
38	94	90	1:27:33 AM	1:50:24	2180
39	101	100	2:12:05 AM	0:44:32	2280
40	82	80	2:59:13 AM	0:47:08	2360
41	100	100	4:52:40 AM	1:53:27	2460
42	81	80	5:39:30 AM	0:46:50	2540
43	29	20	7:56:49 AM	2:17:19	2560
44	55	50	8:09:36 AM	0:12:47	2610
45	62	60	8:22:42 AM	0:13:06	2670
46	63	60	8:56:45 AM	0:34:03	2730
47	58	50	9:17:41 AM	0:20:56	2780
48	30	30	9:47:52 AM	0:30:11	2810
49 (finish)	109		10:52:07 AM	1:04:15	